

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2025年度 第2回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



ReadPassで復習

解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) The couple decided not to buy the house in the countryside because it was so (1). The nearest town was over two hours away by car.

1 stocky 2 cheery 3 ambitious 4 remote

(2) Dogs have excellent hearing compared with humans. There are many sounds that cannot be heard by people but are (2) to dogs.

1 commendable 2 impressionable 3 audible 4 eligible

(3) The new highway should be good for (3) who drive to work from the suburbs. The amount of time needed to drive into the city is expected to drop by 10 percent.

1 invaders 2 commuters 3 composers 4 installers

(4) Roger was eager to sell as many cars as possible because he earned a 20 percent (4) on every sale. He planned to use the extra money to travel around the world.

1 commission 2 script 3 fragment 4 molecule

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q9

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) The doctor told Emma she was suffering from (5) due to overwork. He said that with a break and plenty of rest, however, she would recover quickly.

1 virtue 2 fatigue 3 oversight 4 perception

- (6) Kevin nearly drove into the truck in front of him when it stopped (6). He stepped hard on the brakes and just managed to avoid crashing into it.

1 indifferently 2 appealingly 3 abruptly 4 timidly

- (7) The professor told the class that she would not (7) lateness. She said that any papers not turned in on time would receive a failing grade.

1 clarify 2 implement 3 tolerate 4 humiliate

- (8) While the sun may look small from Earth, it is (8). In fact, it is many times bigger than any planet in the solar system.

1 massive 2 amusing 3 graceful 4 hesitant

- (9) **A:** Majid, remind me how many people we can (9) in Conference Room B.
B: Fifteen, so it should be fine for today's meeting.

1 outlaw 2 elevate 3 plead 4 accommodate

大問1 語彙・文法 Q10-Q14

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (10) The company president was not (10) about the reasons for the layoffs. When asked, he gave only vague answers and avoided any direct comments.
1 alleged 2 forthcoming 3 blissful 4 fainthearted
- (11) The politician claimed he was (11) to no one, but everyone knew he had received donations from many companies to help his campaign.
1 sinister 2 indebted 3 perilous 4 doomed
- (12) Parents were asked to (12) their children to and from the school dance. Since the event would be held in the evening, school officials did not want children going on their own.
1 appoint 2 import 3 acquaint 4 escort
- (13) The cookie factory made one (13) of cookies with salt instead of sugar. They had to throw the entire lot away.
1 aggression 2 substitute 3 relegation 4 batch
- (14) The documentary on the war was so powerful that it (14) strong feelings of sadness and anger in the viewers.
1 dehydrated 2 evoked 3 acquired 4 posed

大問1 語彙・文法 Q15-Q18

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (15) The travel agent warned the couple not to (15) the discount airline's flights being on time. They were often delayed or canceled.

1 take in 2 even out 3 figure on 4 make do

- (16) The country's military was able to (16) the enemy's spy drone before it could gather any information about the country's defenses.

1 hold out 2 shoot down 3 get over 4 snap up

- (17) The city plans to (17) the old theater and build a new one in the same place, but many residents are unhappy about the plan.

1 tune up 2 touch on 3 tear down 4 free up

- (18) **A:** How long will it take to (18) from the mountaintop, Jane?
B: About three hours, but it will take longer if we walk at a slow pace.

1 get down 2 round out 3 die away 4 lay out

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q19-Q21

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Striking Schoolchildren

In 1911, a group of schoolchildren in Wales walked out of their school in protest. They then proceeded to march through the streets of their town, encouraging students from other schools to join them along the way. The strike ended peacefully on the same day, but news of the incident spread to other towns and cities across the country. (19), a series of school strikes occurred across the United Kingdom. In the end, schoolchildren from around sixty schools are thought to have participated in similar protests.

Reports of the initial strike state that it began because of the unfair punishment of a student at the school. However, some historians suggest the reason (20). The strike followed many months of public unrest in the United Kingdom, during which workers called for improved labor conditions and many industrial strikes occurred. The schoolchildren would have seen members of their families participate in these protests, which historians believe inspired them to stand up for their own rights as well.

School authorities attempted to play down the importance of the school strikes by pointing out that only a small percentage of the national school population participated. While this was true, it (21) the protests. For one thing, they represented one of the first times that schoolchildren in the United Kingdom had felt sufficiently empowered to stand up for their rights. The strikes also provided the stimulus for societal reforms that would end up improving child welfare in the United Kingdom.

(19)

- 1 In contrast
- 2 As a result
- 3 Despite this
- 4 For instance

(20)

- 1 made little sense
- 2 remains a mystery
- 3 differed between schools
- 4 was more complex

(21)

- 1 did not lessen the significance of
- 2 was not a good reason to support
- 3 made people suspicious of
- 4 discouraged schoolchildren from joining

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q22-Q24

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

One-Hit Wonders

It is said that nearly half of musicians with songs in America's top one hundred pop song rankings become what are known as "one-hit wonders," or artists who never achieve a second musical success. When researcher Justin Berg looked into which bands (22), he discovered two key factors. The first was novelty, or how different songs are from other current music. The second key factor for career longevity was diversity, or the degree of variety among an artist's own songs. Berg found that artists whose songs had both these qualities early in their careers were far less likely to be one-hit wonders.

This seems logical since novelty and diversity should allow artists to produce work that is entertaining to fans over the long term. (23), too much of these things is not always ideal. According to Berg, songs that are too different from what is currently fashionable have a lower probability of climbing the music rankings in the first place.

Berg also claims that "once artists reach that first hit, then the (24)." Of course, artists who prioritize innovation over fame and fortune can continue producing work that is new and unique. However, artists who desire multiple hits benefit from producing work that is similar to their first success, with only small changes to adapt to new trends. Berg believes that the balance between producing work that reminds listeners of the artist's initial hits while still sounding up-to-date is the true recipe for continued success.

(22)

- 1 were the most imitated 2 had the biggest hits 3 proved this was true 4 were able to avoid this

(23)

- 1 Therefore 2 In other words 3 On the other hand 4 In return

(24)

- 1 time for creativity is over 2 situation gets even worse 3 profits increase greatly 4 audiences tend to reject them

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ25-Q27に答えなさい。

Rocket Science

Some US astronauts became household names in the 1950s and '60s, partly due to the media coverage of their achievements. Behind the scenes, however, others played a crucial role in making US space missions, including the moon landing, successful. Unlike the astronauts, many of these unsung heroes were female. These women, who came to be called human computers, conducted complex calculations in areas such as spacecraft navigation, rocket aerodynamics, and orbital physics. The human computers' calculations-mostly done by hand-were mentally and physically demanding, sometimes each taking a week to complete. Without them, it would have been impossible to launch spacecraft, and any inaccuracies could have had life-threatening consequences for the astronauts.

The women were standing on the shoulders of others who had gone before them. As fields such as astronomy, navigation, and surveying expanded in the nineteenth century, so did the need for mathematical computation. This need only skyrocketed in World War I and World War II. Early computation work had been mainly undertaken by men. However, partly due to the discriminatory nature of contemporary societal norms, employing women meant that salaries-and therefore overall costs-could be dramatically reduced. Gradually, these jobs came to be seen by some as "women's work." Historian Mar Hicks believes that one reason these "pre-electronic computation jobs were feminized is they were seen as rote and de-skilled." Although human-computer work was sometimes repetitive, Hicks points out that it often required advanced math skills.

Around the mid-twentieth century, when Cold War tensions with the Soviet Union escalated, the United States turned more of its attention to space. NASA's predecessor, NACA, employed many women to conduct calculations. The agency was seen as progressive in a few respects-women's pay was relatively high, some women were supervisors, and married women with children were employed. Nevertheless, women were not treated as equals. African American women faced an additional layer of discrimination as they were forced to conduct much of their work in segregated facilities. When NASA was established in 1958, it abolished that policy and also improved other conditions for women.

Time, however, was not on the human computers' side. Space missions became more complex, and the transition to electronic computation negated the need for most human computers. Nonetheless, it was a while before electronic data would be wholly trusted: In the early 1960s, for example, astronaut John Glenn asked Katherine Johnson, an African American human computer, to personally verify computer-calculated orbital equations before he would fly.

大問3A 長文設問 Q25-Q27

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (25) What does the author of the passage say about US space missions in the 1950s and '60s?
- 1 Given the physical demands of space travel, it was understandable that men rather than women were being sent into space.
 - 2 The missions were considered too important to rely on the calculations of human computers.
 - 3 The astronauts at the time felt the media should have given women working on the missions more credit.
 - 4 The missions could only be effectively completed thanks to the precision of the calculations made by human computers.
- (26) Which of the following statements would Mar Hicks most likely agree with?
- 1 The view that computation work was for women stemmed partly from a misunderstanding of the nature of the work.
 - 2 Male mathematicians still played a vital role in the interwar period as the women employed sometimes lacked the necessary math skills.
 - 3 Reducing costs by paying low wages to women ultimately had a negative effect on overall data reliability.
 - 4 The two world wars brought about significant societal changes that benefited women much more than men.
- (27) The author of the passage points out that after NASA was established,
- 1 the focus of the Cold War began to turn away from conducting space-related missions.
 - 2 it made efforts to address some of the inequities that certain human computers had experienced.
 - 3 female supervisors were awarded additional compensation to make up for their historically low wages.
 - 4 it realized that winning the space race would only be possible if it recruited some of the Soviet Union's human computers.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ28-Q31に答えなさい。

Relying on Nature

It was once thought that the use of medicine was a uniquely human trait, but over the past fifty years or so, scientists have reported many cases of animals using natural remedies to self-medicate. Plants produce many chemical substances to protect themselves against disease or prevent themselves from being eaten by animals and insects, and some of these chemicals have medicinal properties. A growing body of research shows that animals have learned to recognize and consume these substances to treat and prevent illnesses.

Self-medication by animals was first recorded in the 1970s by researchers studying a group of chimpanzees in Tanzania. They observed some chimpanzees in the group swallowing the leaves of plants that were not a part of their regular diet. Since the chimpanzees were swallowing the leaves whole without chewing them, they were obviously not consuming them for nutritional purposes, and further observations revealed that the behavior occurred more frequently when stomach parasites were common among the group. The researchers hypothesized that the leaves were being used to remove the parasites, and they used the term "zoopharmacognosy" to refer to this self-medicating behavior.

For many years, it was believed by most scientists that this behavior was limited to animals with advanced intellectual ability. This belief originated mainly from the initial observations of chimpanzees, which suggested that the behavior had to be learned and passed on from generation to generation. However, a recent review of research has shown that self-medication is much more common than was previously thought and is even demonstrated by some insects. This suggests that self-medication must also occur by instinct, and many scientists now believe that it can be both innate and learned, even in more intelligent animals.

One of the best-studied examples of self-medication in insects is that of fruit flies. These tiny flies are often targeted by a type of parasitic wasp that lays its eggs inside the flies' bodies. Research has shown that fruit flies infected by parasitic wasps deliberately consume food containing alcohol, such as rotting fruit. The alcohol prevents the development of the wasp larvae and protects the flies. Consuming food with high alcohol content is normally harmful to the flies, so they avoid doing so when they are healthy. This implies that something triggers them to seek out such food only when they have wasp larvae inside them, and scientists seem to have determined the chemical compound that causes it. In other studies, it has also been found that the use of natural medication by some social insects goes beyond self-medication. When bacterial and fungal infections occur within an ant colony, for example, the insects collect resin from nearby trees and take it back to the colony. The resin has antibacterial and antifungal properties, so by doing this, the ants are performing a form of "social medication."

Many scientists believe it is likely that our human ancestors gained knowledge of medicinal plants by observing the behavior of animals. They also hope that further research into zoopharmacognosy will help to improve human health care by providing clues to new sources of medicines.

大問3B 長文設問 Q28-Q31

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(28) What did a group of researchers in the 1970s conclude?

- 1 Most of the reported cases of animals using natural substances for medicinal purposes were false.
- 2 Most chemical substances produced by plants were harmful to animals even when only consumed in small amounts.
- 3 Chimpanzees supplemented their diets with leaves when they could not get adequate nutrition from their usual food sources.
- 4 Chimpanzees deliberately ate the leaves of certain plants when they were suffering from parasitic infections.

(29) What did most scientists believe for many years?

- 1 Animals did not self-medicate because consuming unknown substances went against their natural instincts.
- 2 The kinds of plants that animals used for medicinal purposes changed from one generation to the next.
- 3 Animals with low intelligence could not self-medicate because they lacked the ability to learn how to do so.
- 4 All animals were born with the ability to recognize natural substances that have medicinal properties.

(30) What is one thing the author of the passage says about fruit flies?

- 1 Consuming alcohol is damaging to their health but overall beneficial when they are infected by parasitic wasps.
- 2 The consumption of food containing alcohol weakens them and makes them more vulnerable to parasitic wasps.
- 3 They intentionally become infected by parasitic wasps in order to reduce the harmful effects of alcohol.
- 4 They have developed a strategy to prevent parasitic wasps from being able to lay eggs inside them.

(31) Research has shown that some social insects

- 1 produce a substance that can protect themselves and their colony from bacterial and fungal infections.
- 2 leave their colony when they are suffering from infectious diseases to prevent the disease from spreading.
- 3 use natural medication in a way that benefits their whole colony rather than just themselves.
- 4 have the ability to teach other members of their colony how to deal with bacterial and fungal infections.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q11	Q12-Q21	Q22-Q31
Q014 remote 4	Q124 escort 4	Q224 were able to avoid this 4
Q023 audible 3	Q133 batch 4	Q233 On the other hand 3
Q032 commuters 2	Q142 evoked 2	Q241 time for creativity is over 1
Q041 commission 1	Q153 figure on 3	Q254 4
Q052 fatigue 2	Q162 shoot down 2	Q261 1
Q063 abruptly 3	Q173 tear down 3	Q272 2
Q072 tolerate 3	Q181 get down 1	Q284 4
Q081 massive 1	Q192 As a result 2	Q293 3
Q094 accommodate 4	Q204 was more complex 4	Q301 1
Q102 forthcoming 2	Q211 did not lessen the significance of 1	Q313 3
Q112 indebted 2		

学習記録

得点

 / 31

やり直す問題

メモ
